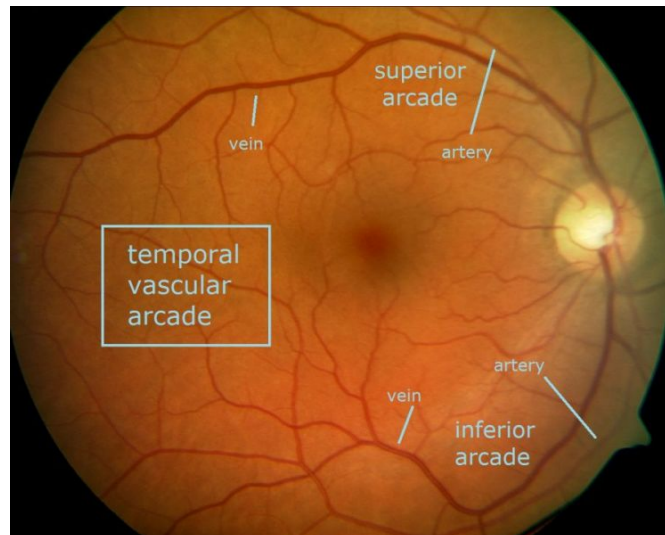


Orient yourself in the normal fundus

Trace the vascular arcades toward the disc and distinguish arteries from veins.



Normal fundus: vessels converge at the optic disc, with the macula temporal to it; veins are wider and darker than arteries.

Read the structures systematically

Identify the disc before describing its colour and margins, then follow the vessels and inspect the surrounding retina. Veins have a wider calibre and darker colour than arteries. The vascular arcades provide orientation, while the macula occupies the central visual region. A familiar normal appearance helps separate genuine pathology from an unfamiliar view or poor focus.

Choose the view and illumination

The ophthalmoscope’s filters serve different purposes and should match the examination.

Technique with a purpose

Technique	Purpose
Corresponding examiner eye and hand	Right for right, left for left; approach temporally.
Distant fixation and dim room	Facilitate a stable view without near accommodation.
Red-free green illumination	Enhance retinal vessel contrast.
Fluorescein with cobalt blue	Highlight corneal epithelial staining.

Start with the red reflex

Compare the brightness and symmetry of the reflex before moving close for the retinal examination. Dark interruptions can indicate media opacities along the optical path. Once a clear vessel is visible, follow its branches toward the optic disc. Keep macular illumination brief when asking the patient to look directly at the light.